



Changing Priorities for the CEO

The focus is on making organisations outcome-oriented by bringing together differentiating capabilities and multidimensional skill sets

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PWC'S 25TH ANNUAL Global CEO Survey, launched on January 17 this year, underlines a direct correlation between customer experience and the top line. Unhappy customers today not only make for a source of learning but also, as the pandemic has made evident, impact revenue and brand. This has put the spotlight on the customer, not the brand.

Of the India CEOs polled for the survey, 81 per cent included customer satisfaction metrics in their company's long-term corporate strategy, while 78 per cent and 75 per cent considered automation and digitisation goals, and employee engagement metrics, respectively. These non-financial outcomes are intertwined with day-to-day business performance. Much less well-represented, in strategies and compensation, are targets related to greenhouse gas emissions and workforce gender representation or racial and ethnic diversity. This indicates that despite the rising interest in ESG (environmental, social, and governance) globally, strategy is still primarily driven by business metrics, and not so much by social and environmental outcomes.



ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

The survey findings also show that CEOs are increasingly focussed on building trust in this changing paradigm. The Union Budget 2022, too, with its focus on inclusive development, productivity enhancement, energy transition and climate change shows the government's commitment to factor in trust as it prepares the blueprint for a fit-for-future India.

This is in alignment with what is top of mind for CEOs. The PwC CEO Survey shows that CEOs with greater trust are more confident and more likely to lead organisations that have made a net-zero commitment.

This indirectly suggests a correlation between trust and the ability to drive change amid the demand-supply revolution. On the demand side,